RoboCupJunior International General Rules

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These rules apply to the international RoboCupJunior competition. However, Regional, SuperRegional, and local tournaments may have variations or adaptations to these rules to suit their specific competition needs. It is important to check with the organizers of the tournaments you are participating in to confirm which exact rules will be in use.

If teams are unsure about any aspects of the General Rules or specific League Rules, they are encouraged to inquire via the official RoboCupJunior Forum for clarification: https://junior.forum.robocup.org/

For questions regarding any of the rules or RoboCupJunior in general, teams can also reach out to the RoboCupJunior community through the official Discord Server.

Getting Started

Students, parents, teachers and mentors who are new to RoboCupJunior can follow the Getting Started guides on the Official Website, from building a first robot to entering a first competition.

1. **Starting a Team**: Form a team, build a robot, keep costs down and find tutorials for your league.
2. **Qualification and Competitions**: How the season works, how regions qualify teams, and how to enter events outside your region.
3. **Your First Competition**: What to expect at an event, what to pack, and how to handle things going wrong.
4. **For Educators**: Why robotics works in schools, and how to start a program with your students.

Team Requirements

Team Definition

Team: A team is defined by its robot(s) and the student members who built and developed them. The team members are the students who carry out the work of designing, building and programming the robot(s) being entered. Membership may change between competition levels in accordance with the Team Continuity rule. New members must contribute to this work before competing.

Technical Roles: Every team member must have a defined technical role (mechanical/design,

electrical/sensing, software etc.) and must be able to explain their role and their contributions to the robot(s) during technical judging. Non-technical roles, such as documentation, poster or graphic design, or presentation, may be shared by team members but do not on their own count as a technical role.

Junior Mentor: A Junior Mentor is a supervisor who meets the Age Requirements and supports and guides the student team members. Junior Mentors are not team members and must not do the design, building or programming work for the team (see Mentoring and Onsite Assistance).

Team Size

Minimum Team Size: Teams must consist of at least 2 members.

Maximum Team Size:

- Soccer and Rescue Leagues: 4 members.
- OnStage League: 5 members.

Regional and SuperRegional competitions may define their own team sizes depending on their venue capacity and regional variations. Teams attending the International competition must comply with the maximum team size for their league, regardless of their team size at the qualifying competition.

Shared Members and Robots: No team member(s) or robot(s) may be shared between teams.

Team Continuity: A team that qualifies for a higher level of competition (from a Regional to a SuperRegional or International competition) must include at least one member of the qualifying team when competing at the next level. New members may be added within the maximum team size for the league. These membership changes do not prevent the team from entering its robot(s), but qualification and robot(s) may not be transferred to a separate team. All continuing and new members must meet the Technical Roles requirement.

Team Supervision

Junior Mentor Requirement: Each Junior team must have at least one Junior Mentor registered and attending with the team.

Mentors and Parent/Chaperones are responsible for supervising their teams and maintain a duty of care/well being for their team members, as appropriate for their home region's regulations. Any concerns regarding team member welfare should be brought to the attention of the event organizers immediately.

The Junior Mentor must be present at the venue during all official competition events, but may not enter the competition areas during rounds and interviews. They must not interact in an imposing manner with teams, robots, judges, or the judging process. Any incident considered inappropriate will be handled by the event organizers and may lead to disciplinary actions.

Age Requirements

Junior Student Members: Must be 14 to 19 years old (inclusive) as of July 1st of the competition year.

Junior Mentors and Parent/Chaperones: Must be 19 years or older as of July 1st of the competition year.

Entry Leagues: RoboCupJunior Entry leagues and other "Primary" divisions are not run at the International competition but feature in many Regional and SuperRegional competitions. Age requirements for these divisions may differ from the student age range above and are set by the organizers of each competition.

Robot Requirements

Robot Communication

Permitted Communication: Communication between robots during competition rounds is allowed as long as it uses the 2.4GHz spectrum and its power output does not exceed 100 mW EIRP (Effective Isotropic Radiated Power) under any circumstances.

Responsibility: Teams are responsible for managing their robot communication. Teams must ensure their wireless equipment and its use comply with host-country regulations. Spectrum availability is not guaranteed.

Component Communication: Communication between components of the same robot is permitted.

League Adaptability: Each league may modify the robot communication rules to ensure they meet their specific requirements.

Safety and Power Requirements

Electrical Power:

- Robots must not use mains electricity.
- Maximum allowed voltage: 48V DC or 25V AC RMS (Root Mean Square).
- Voltage must be easily measured during inspections, and measuring points must be covered for safety or designed with safety considerations in place.

Battery Safety:

- Lithium batteries must be stored in safety bags, and charging must be supervised by team members in competition areas.
- Teams must follow safety protocols, including battery fire handling and evacuation procedures.

Robot Safety Design:

- **Power Management**: Batteries must be securely mounted, wiring must be safe, and every robot

must have an accessible way to cut power to immediately in emergency situations.

- **Mechanical Safety**: Robots must not have sharp edges, pinch points, or other hazards. Actuators must be appropriate for the robot's size and function.
- **Hazardous Behavior**: Teams must report potentially dangerous robot behaviors to the event organizers at least two weeks before a RoboCupJunior event. Behavior discovered later must be reported as soon as it is discovered and must not be used in competition until the organizers approve it.

Documentation and Sharing Requirements

RoboCupJunior Team Posters

Purpose: Posters are a tool for sharing robot designs and insights with judges, teams, and the public. Posters will be hung in public competition areas in the venue and digital copies or photographs will be shared by RoboCupJunior after the competition.

Size: Posters must be no larger than A1 size (59.4 x 84.1 cm).

Content: Posters should summarize design documents and present the robot's capabilities in an engaging format.

Technical Description Video (See League Documentation)

Content:

- **Robotic Demonstration**: Show fully functional robot systems to highlight technical aspects.
- **Design Process**: Explain design choices and team problem-solving approaches.
- **Presentation**: Clear and high-quality, explaining innovative or unusual techniques.
- **Innovation & Sustainability**: Highlight new technologies and sustainable practices.

Submission: Guidelines will specify video length and deadlines per league.

Sharing Team Resources

Sharing: Materials submitted by teams as part of the documentation submission will be shared on GitHub repositories for the leagues: https://github.com/robocup-junior

Credit: Teams must credit creators of external work and adhere to licensing rules. The focus should remain on personal growth and learning.

Plagiarism Guidelines

External Code Use: Teams are allowed to use external code but must credit the original creators.

Learning Priority: Teams should prioritize learning and not use complete solutions from others. Always pay attention to licensing rules.

Acceptable Uses of AI

Generative AI tools and technologies used to create content in a team's code and documentation (including but not limited to text, figures, images) must be disclosed. The AI system used must be identified and be accompanied by a brief explanation regarding the manner in which the AI system was used to generate the content. The use of AI systems for editing and grammar enhancement or translation to English is common practice and does not need to be specified.

Bill of Materials (BOM)

Submission: Teams must submit a BOM (Bill of Materials) listing major components and materials used.

Details: The BOM must include:

- Component name/description (e.g., part number).
- Supplier/source of the component (including PCBs/machined components).
- Status (new/reused).
- Kit or custom-built.
- Price.

Template: A standardized BOM template will be provided with the league documentation submissions for the international competition.

Spirit and Behavior

Behavior

All participants are expected to behave themselves and be considerate and polite especially but not only towards other participants, volunteers, referees and organizers of all Junior and Major Leagues as well as the host venue.

Code of Conduct

All organizers, volunteers, team members, mentors, supporters and visitors must abide by the RoboCup Code of Ethics and Conduct. Any situation that does not meet the Code must be reported as set out in the Code, which gives the formal reporting address (conduct@robocup.org) and what to do at the event, including in an emergency.

Mentoring and Onsite Assistance

Support from other teams, mentors, teachers, parents, sponsors, internet communities etc. is a core part of how teams learn and grow.

To ensure fair competition and maximize learning it is required that none of the support they receive does the work of competing for the team. A good indication is the team's ability to explain not only what their robots' components do but also how they do it.

Teams Onsite

- During the competition, only the official team members can represent the team at registration, setup-day, and have access to the competition areas for rounds and interviews.
- There must be at least 2 team members on-site, unless a team can present evidence of extenuating circumstances, including proof of travel for other team members. Teams where only one team member is present at the venue without such evidence will be able to compete, but will not be eligible for finals or awards.
- It is the teams' responsibility to ensure that team members are present at the correct time and location for all scheduled activities.
- Teams are not allowed to communicate with or receive help virtually from external parties with the intention of impacting the team’s performance during the competition. Virtually communicating includes but is not limited to phone calls, video calls, remote desktop control etc.
- Any team found to be in breach of these rules may be subject to disciplinary action.
- Teams are recommended to seek help from other teams, or organizers if they are struggling with any issues onsite.

Violations

Teams, Junior Mentors, Parent/Chaperones or Team Members that repeatedly or seriously conduct themselves in an unacceptable way or in violation of the General or League Rules may be disqualified from the tournament and asked to leave the venue.